reds and immoral conduct, and organizations began forming around the country with the declared purpose of censoring the movies.

Like any big group of people, we had our bad apples, but they were in the minority and most of the anti-Hollywood propaganda wasn't true. As president of the Screen Actors Guild, I began speaking out to defend the industry.

At first, I just spoke to others in Hollywood and motion picture theater owners, encouraging them to get together to improve our industry's image and its public relations by speaking out against the critics and columnists who unfairly maligned us. I described how we'd responded to the Communist threat in the industry, pointed out that the life-style of the majority of people in Hollywood was tame, and tried to emphasize how important the movies were to American culture. Pretty soon, I was giving a couple of speeches a week, and as time went on, I was speaking less frequently to others in the industry and more often to groups like the Rotary Club and local Chambers of Commerce.

By now, I guess I was beginning to undergo a political transformation. As I've said, Pd emerged from the war a liberal: Like my father, I mistrusted business and believed government could solve all our country's problems, as it had during the Depression. Only later did I realize it was probably World War II that ended the Depression. I think my political transformation began with my exposure to the business-as-usual attitude of many civil service bureaucrats during the war; then came the attempted Communist take-over of the picture business, which a lot of my liberal friends refused to admit ever happened; next, I had a brief experience living in a country that promised the kind of womb-to-tomb utopian benevolence a lot of these liberal friends wanted to bring to America. In 1949, I spent four months in England filming *The Hasty Heart* while the Labor